INTERN LEADERSHIP & SYLLABUS ALIGNMENT

Creative coaching framework for the Social Media & Community Growth Manager

Spring 2027 and future internship cohorts

LEAD THE WORK • DEVELOP THE INTERN • BUILD THE FINAL PROJECT

1. Purpose

This guide gives Ava a practical way to lead SitGuru interns day to day while preserving the educational structure of the employer internship syllabus. The syllabus determines the learning components and final deliverables; Ava helps interns satisfy those requirements through real, creative, measurable SitGuru work.

Core principle: weekly work should advance both SitGuru growth and the intern's final Market Growth Project.

2. Leadership Model

Area	Ava	Jason
Day-to-day work	Lead priorities, coaching, project sequencing, creative review and routine readiness.	Set company priorities and remain available for strategic or founder-level decisions.
Creativity	Create the space for interns to propose approaches, experiments, content and community-growth ideas.	Avoid becoming the routine creative approval gate.
Syllabus	Monitor learning components, evidence, weekly contribution and final-project development.	Remain the formal employer supervisor of record unless an institution-approved arrangement says otherwise.

Area	Ava	Jason
Formal approvals	Escalate hours, university forms, formal performance concerns and required evaluations.	Complete official employer/university approvals, verifications and evaluations.

3. How Ava Uses the Syllabus

For each meaningful assignment, campaign, experiment, event activity, or research project, connect four layers:

1. SitGuru business objective - what problem or opportunity are we addressing?
2. Intern learning objective - which syllabus component is being practiced?
3. Evidence - what will prove the work and learning happened?
4. Final-project contribution - what should carry forward into the Market Growth Playbook, Business Growth Report, portfolio case study, or final presentation?

4. Creative Freedom Framework

Ava should not have to invent every idea. The internship should gradually teach interns to think, recommend, test, and learn.

Level	When to Use	What It Sounds Like
Explore	Research, strategy, experiments, concept development.	"Here is the problem and the guardrails. Tell me how you would approach it."
Guided	Most campaign, event, content and community work.	"Here is the objective and audience. You own the creative execution; bring me your recommendation."
Directed	Compliance, exact brand requirements, fixed deliverables, formal deadlines.	"This item has specific requirements. Follow them exactly, then bring your ideas within those boundaries."

Target culture: most substantial internship work should be Explore or Guided. Interns should have room to respectfully disagree, explain their reasoning, and suggest better approaches.

5. Planner Assignment Standard

- Objective
- Audience
- Deliverable
- Success measure

- Evidence required
- Creative freedom level
- Syllabus / learning component
- Final-project contribution
- Resources / approved tools
- Review point / due date

Planner manages the work. SitGuru Messaging manages routine operational communication. Teams supports meetings and collaborative sessions. The Intern Portal remains the formal internship record. The Growth Workspace measures business outcomes.

6. Fifteen-Week Coaching Map

Phase	Timing	Builds Toward	Ava's Coaching Role
I	**Weeks 1-2**	Baseline & Growth Brief	Teach SitGuru context; encourage observation; help establish market definition, audience research, baseline metrics and SMART targets.
II	**Weeks 3-5**	Strategy + campaign system	Ask the intern to propose audience strategy, content pillars, channels, calendar, creative templates and tracking.
III	**Weeks 6-11**	Experiments + Business Growth Report	Increase autonomy. Coach hypothesis -> action -> result -> learning -> next change. Treat failed tests as learning when documented honestly.
IV	**Weeks 12-14**	Playbook handoff	Help identify winning channels, repeatable tactics, SOPs, templates, asset library and recommendations.
V	**Week 15**	Final package + presentation	Coach verified metrics, synthesis, portfolio-safe storytelling, recommendations and next-90-day actions.

7. Weekly Intern Development Check

Use these questions during the regular team/individual coaching rhythm. They supplement, rather than replace, the formal weekly report in the Intern Portal.

- What are you working on, and what business problem is it meant to solve?
- What did you finish or learn this week?
- What did the numbers or feedback show?
- What did not work, and what would you change?
- Which learning objective did this advance?
- What evidence should be retained?
- What should carry into your final project?
- What would you like to own or test next?

8. Shaping the Final Project

Do not wait until the end of the term to "pick" a final project. The project should emerge from the intern's strongest and most relevant semester work. Ava should help the intern identify a coherent story and progressively save the evidence needed to tell it.

- Problem / opportunity
- Starting baseline
- Audience insight
- Strategy / hypothesis
- Execution / experiments
- Verified outcomes
- What worked / what did not
- Learning / limitations
- Reusable assets / SOPs
- Evidence-based recommendation
- Next 90-day actions

9. Review & Approval Workflow

INTERN -> AVA REVIEW / COACHING -> ROUTINE WORK MOVES FORWARD -> JASON ONLY WHEN REQUIRED

- Ava approves routine creative readiness and asks for revisions.
- Jason is not a required checkpoint for every caption, organic post, research task, routine event assignment, or normal intern deliverable.
- Escalate major spending, paid advertising, significant partnerships, legal/policy issues, sensitive company messaging, formal personnel matters, university documentation, hour verification, or required employer evaluations.
- Work approval, hour approval, and KPI verification remain distinct decisions. Strong learning can occur even when an experiment misses its target.

10. What Ava Reports to Jason

Use the private weekly Growth & Leadership 1:1 to keep founder oversight strategic rather than intrusive.

- Interns on track / at risk
- Hours pace or university requirement concerns
- Current learning milestone
- Strongest recent work or learning
- Potential final-project direction
- Where an intern needs more coaching or more autonomy
- Formal issues requiring supervisor action
- What Ava needs from Jason to keep the team moving

10A. Managing Intern Communications

Use SitGuru Messaging as the normal operational communication channel for assigned intern work. Community messaging permissions should match the intern's development stage and assignment needs, not simply their internship status.

Stage	Messaging authority	Ava's role
Early / Directed	Reply to assigned conversations or prepare drafts; selected community messages require review.	Review before send, coach tone/accuracy/authority/privacy, and document meaningful feedback.
Developing / Guided	Respond within approved audiences/guardrails; selected higher-risk messages still require review.	Spot-check, coach exceptions, and expand autonomy when judgment improves.
Independent within guardrails	Handle approved routine conversations independently.	Monitor workload/outcomes, intervene on risk, and escalate serious concerns.

- Keep official outreach in SitGuru Messaging or another specifically approved SitGuru business channel. Do not require interns to use personal phone numbers, personal email, personal social DMs, or personal messaging apps for assigned SitGuru work.
- Use Internal Notes for coaching/handoff context that must not be visible to the community participant.
- If an intern reports a concern involving you, the issue should be routed to Founder/Admin. Do not retaliate or require the intern to resolve the concern directly with you first.
- Serious safety, harassment, discrimination, sexual/inappropriate conduct, privacy, credential/payment, fraud/scam, legal, or reputational concerns should be escalated promptly.

10A. Approved Systems & Software

Use the systems that best support learning and real SitGuru work, provided they are approved for the applicable role and task. SitGuru Messaging, Teams, Planner, the Intern Portal, the Growth Workspace, SharePoint, Canva, social platforms, analytics tools, and other tools named in program materials are examples - not a closed list.

- Ava may recommend or request additional software when it could improve intern learning, creative production, research, analytics, surveys, events, Ambassador work, or team coordination.
- Interns may use other SitGuru-approved tools when authorized, but they do not independently add software that receives SitGuru confidential information or customer data.
- AI-assisted tools may be used only when approved for the specific type of work and only with intern-safe, non-confidential information unless SitGuru explicitly authorizes otherwise.
- Tool choice should support the syllabus and final project; it should not create duplicate reporting or require the intern to enter the same work into unnecessary systems.

11. Success Standard

A successful SitGuru internship should produce both useful business work and visible student development. By the end of 15 weeks, the intern should be able to explain what they contributed, why they made key choices, how they measured results, what failed, what they learned, and what they recommend SitGuru do next.

CREATE • TEST • LEARN • IMPROVE • HAND OFF